

In another case, an affluent couple had a twelve-year-old daughter who was very shy and rarely spoke to anyone without some prompting. Concerned about her daughter, the mother wrote a note to her daughter's teacher, asking that the child's seat be moved from the front to the back of the room, since her daughter felt more comfortable there. The mother reported that the "kids in front were too often asked questions by their teacher." The day the teacher received this request, she did not make any changes in the seating. The mother called the teacher that afternoon to protest. The teacher was unavailable, but she did return the call the next afternoon. Feeling slighted, the mother immediately transferred her daughter to another school.

In yet another case, a distinguished professor recently received a telephone call from his neighbor. The caller was irate:

Caller: Dr_____, you're in this business. I need your advice. How can I go about getting a professor fired? You probably don't know this guy. He's at the state university.

Professor: Why do you want to have him fired?

Caller: My daughter is failing his course. He says she lacks the background to do well in his class.... He has long hair. He never wears a suit.... He's a jerk! I have already spoken to his chairman. I'm getting the runaround. I want this guy fired.

Professor: Well, why doesn't your daughter just withdraw from the class?

Caller: Then she will have to go to summer school.

Professor: There are a lot worse things than summer school.

Caller: If she goes to summer school, she can't go to Europe with us. We have planned this trip for two years. Her mother won't go without her daughter. What can I do?

What have all the parents done in these cases? They have contributed to weakening the weak. If your son has a deficiency in his verbal skills, make a commitment to overcome his handicap. In one case, a father recognized that his son had an extremely high aptitude in mathematics but that his verbal skills were poor. His dad attacked the problem. Each night during dinner, Dad would ask his son to define three words taken